

**FOR TRADERS**

**PLAIN-ENGLISH GUIDE**

# **RETAIL TRADING IS BROKEN**

**95%  
FAIL  
RATE  
EXPOSED**

## **AND HERE'S THE PROOF**

**Why 95% of retail traders fail — what the industry  
never tells you — and how structure changes  
everything**



**DTB TRADERS**

By Jason Taylor - Founder, DTB Traders

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## Why This Book Exists



Retail trading is BROKEN, 95% of retail traders fail, this book explains why and how to change that.

Most individuals who enter the trading space are time poor, they already have full time careers that demand a lot of attention and are under a lot of pressure to perform as a result - the last thing anyone needs is to go study the hundreds of chart patterns being promoted to try dig out one for them!

Trading is marketed as “easy” and if you just look for this pattern or that pattern, mark out this sequence of bars, review market volume, enter here and there, THEN you will be successful.

The reality is that if ANY of those “patterns” or “methods” were consistent then they could be easily automated. You will see catch phrases like 30, 60 or 90 minute “method” or “1 market, 1 strategy, 1 time slot”, but ask yourself, IF any of these worked consistently, then WHY have they not been automated!? YouTube shorts and Instagram shorts sells this belief and it is not helping anybody. MOST Trading education is centred around this approach, and it’s very misguided!

I’ve been around financial markets for a little over nineteen years, read every book, listened to every podcast and studied every “chart pattern” and “candlestick pattern” that exists, seen every marketing company peddling their “magic bullet”, one week this and next week that....

I’m not a “professional trader” in the way that word gets used online. I don’t trade inside a bank, a hedge fund, or a prop firm. I don’t sit on a dealing desk surrounded by risk managers, research analysts, or execution teams. There’s no internal flow coming across my screen. No coordinated desk positioning. No real-time macro briefings. It’s just me and the structure in front of me.

And that matters. I trade in the same environment most people reading this do — Retail platforms, retail “off the top” data, and no institutional infrastructure behind the screen. So if we’re operating in the same environment, then the real question isn’t access.

It's this:

Why do outcomes vary so widely?

The word "professional" gets used constantly in retail trading, not for clarity, but for marketing. It is there to draw you in, manufacture authority, and sell you an idea, a system, or a course. The authority works because it borrows the language and image of a professional environment that retail trading is not.

Retail trading is not the professional environment it is so often disguised as.

My early exposure into trading wasn't grounded. It wasn't "here's how this game works", like most it was visuals, certainty, and stories, trading presented as something you learn to interpret, like you're decoding the market if you just get smart enough and consume all the information you could, you would be successful!

So I did what capable people usually do when something seems rewarding and has opportunity.

I took it seriously and consumed everything I could from every angle to find the solution.

I studied more. Refined more. Added complexity. Stacked indicators. Improved rules. Tightened process.

And when results didn't stabilise, I did what most thoughtful people do:

I assumed the missing piece was me.

It wasn't, and this took me MANY years to realize!

The issue wasn't effort, intelligence, or discipline.

The issue was clarity.

Clarity about the role a retail trader is placed into.

Clarity about the environment shaping behaviour long before the profit and loss ever reflects it.

Clarity about what problems are solvable and which ones are manufactured by structure.

This book exists because that clarity is almost never offered at the beginning, which is the only time it actually prevents damage and saves you time, LOTS of it.

It turns out that a person does not need to spend years and years trying different tools and systems and methods and be consumed with all the noise if they were just presented with something clear and practical from the outset, and once you actually see structure, it all makes sense, and his book leads to that!

This book was not written to impress or persuade you, it's written to remove confusion so you do not have to spend the next few years working in an environment structurally misaligned, but instead work in an environment based on common sense and clarity which few outsiders will ever be able to discover on their own.

Some people will read this and decide trading isn't for them.

Good. That's a win. There are MANY opportunities in this World, don't stop until you find yours!

Others will finally realise why their experience never matched what they were told to expect.

Also a win, and this is a BIG win because clarity ALWAYS improves judgement and decisions!

This is for people who want coherence over hype, structure over stories, and clarity over motivation, the kind of person who would rather understand the terrain before deciding whether to step onto it.

Nothing here requires belief.

Just attention.

## A Necessary Orientation

This book doesn't begin with techniques. That's intentional.

Most traders are trained to look for the "how" first — the tool, the setup, the shortcut they can apply tonight.

Do something.

Add something.

Adjust something.

Anything except step back and ask what game they're actually playing and what is the terrain that is trading.

The early chapters aren't philosophy. They're orientation.

They clarify the environment you're operating inside, the part almost nobody explains, and the part that quietly determines what your effort can and can't produce.

Would it not make sense to understand what you are getting into before actually doing it?

Would it not make sense to understand structure, boundaries and flow before making decisions?

If you skip that, you'll meet the DTB System as just another method. Another set of rules layered onto noise.

Another thing to try. Maybe expecting another "chart pattern" or "candlestick analysis" setup you know doesn't actually work consistently.

And that's not what this is.

If the structure makes sense and it is clear, the system will make sense.

If you skip the structure, you'll misunderstand the system — even if you're smart.

Access is available today, but if you want to evaluate it properly, read this first.

Not because I need you to.

Because you should understand what you're stepping into before you judge it.

At the end of this book I will show you how to access a fully inclusive trading System and included Jump Start training program so you can finally discover if trading is worth your time. Complimentary 1 month access which does include the training course (roughly 20 hours of clear visuals and videos) that you can work through at your own pace so as to not overwhelm, even for absolute beginners!

1 Month guided implementation of a System of tools laying out price in a clear and structured way.

This approach removes guessing and the need to look for "pictures" or study every candle formed to see if they make up an imaginary chart pattern, freeing up your time so you can make trading decisions looking at what actually matters, the right information! Once price range is understood and the concept of raw tick data with guaranteed price levels, the fundamentals are covered and we build on that clean and solid structure!

Are you excited about Automation?

Great news, we include an Automated setup that you will learn to "manage" – think of it like having a high performance team you oversee and your guidance takes them to the next level! A lot of people struggle with manual trading, timing those entries, managing your participation is a much cleaner way and its only 1 step removed from actually manually pulling the trigger but with 70% less mental energy used!

Not all the specifics are covered in this short eBook, but if you GET what is covered, then you are the right person to take advantage of this because you will already see WHY this approach makes perfect sense!

Not a trial. Not a stripped-down version. The full structure. Coherence comes before implementation.

Read it.

Then decide.

# Chapter 1

## The Quiet Failure

The promise is always attractive.

One market. One setup. One session. One simple framework. No noise, no confusion, no endless screen time. Just follow the rules, manage the risk, stay disciplined, and let the maths do the rest.

It sounds clean because it is clean. That is why it works so well in marketing and comes at an unbelievable price point.

Most traders are already tired when they hear it. Tired of charts, indicators, changing methods, second-guessing decisions, and wondering why effort never seems to become confidence. So, when someone offers a smaller frame, it feels like relief.

But relief is not the same as clarity.

A compact method can feel clear simply because it removes complexity from view. That does not mean the complexity has been understood. It only means fewer parts of it are visible.

This is where many traders get caught.

They are not careless. They are not lazy. They are not looking for magic. Most are trying to become more focused, more disciplined, more structured. So when a method says, "Do less," it sounds mature.

Trade one market. Watch one session. Follow one setup. Trust one routine.

There is truth in some of that. Less noise can help. But less noise is not the same as better structure.

A trader can reduce the screen time, reduce the tools, reduce the session, reduce the rules, and still be operating inside the same flawed frame. The same candle interpretation. The same pressure to read the moment correctly. The same belief that if the rules are simple enough, the outcome should eventually become consistent.

That is the danger.

A simple method gives the mind something to hold onto. It narrows attention and creates routine. But if the structure underneath is incomplete, the simplicity becomes fragile.

At first, it may feel better. There are fewer decisions, fewer distractions, fewer things to blame. Then the market does what markets do. It hesitates, shifts, moves just far enough to raise doubt, gives a clean-looking setup that fails, then gives a messy-looking setup that works.

And suddenly the trader is back in the same place.

Not because the rules were ignored. Because the rules were never enough to explain the environment.

This is the quiet failure.

It often begins with a reasonable trade. The chart is familiar, the setup appears, the rules allow it, and the risk is defined. So you take it.

Not emotionally. Not recklessly. Not because you abandoned the plan.

You take it because the method says this is the kind of moment you are supposed to take.

Then price moves against you. Not violently. Not enough to prove anything. Just enough to make you watch more closely.

The trade is still inside the rules. The stop still makes sense. The process has not technically failed. But internally, something changes.

You are no longer observing the market. You are waiting for the method to be right.

A tick in your favour feels like confirmation. A tick against you feels like warning. A pause feels meaningful. A small rejection feels personal.

The trade has become more than a position. It has become a test of whether the frame can hold.

That is where the pressure begins. Not when the trade loses. Before that.

It begins when the trader realises the method has not removed uncertainty. It has only given uncertainty a smaller room to move around in.

So the blame turns inward.

Maybe you hesitated. Maybe you entered too early. Maybe you should have skipped it. Maybe you did not follow the framework cleanly enough. Maybe your discipline slipped.

That explanation is convenient because it protects the method.

If the method is simple, and the rules are clear, then any failure must belong to the person applying them.

But discipline is not the same as clarity.

Risk management matters. Routine matters. Rules matter. But they cannot repair a weak structure, complete an incomplete view, or turn a narrow setup into a full understanding of price.

This is what most trading marketing leaves out.

The market is not simple just because the offer is simple. Price is not clear just because the checklist is short. Risk is not fully understood just because the position size is controlled.

Before you can judge any method, you have to understand the frame it sits inside.

Before you can trust simplicity, you have to know what has been removed.

And before trading can become lighter, you have to see why it became heavy.

Not what trading looks like.

What it quietly asks you to carry.

## Chapter 2

### What You Thought Trading Was



Most people don't come to trading with a definition.  
They come with a picture.

A chart on a screen.  
Price moving.  
Someone pointing at it with confidence, explaining what they see.

Before you ever place a trade, the image is already formed.

Trading looks visual. Interpretive.  
Something you succeed at by seeing what others don't.

And that instinct isn't wrong.

You do need to recognize when something meaningful changes.  
You do need to separate signal from background movement.

But here's the problem:

The environment most retail traders are placed into fragments price into constant candles, named patterns, and time-based formations.



So interpretation becomes reactive instead of structural.

You're not reading participation. You're reacting to shapes.

Education reinforces it. Platforms reinforce it. Commentary reinforces it.

"Read the market." "Price is telling a story." "This confirms the idea."

It sounds reasonable.

It mirrors how intelligent people solve problems everywhere else — gather information, analyze carefully, refine decisions.

So you did exactly that.

You learned what to look for. You refined your entries. You tightened confirmation. You improved context.

And when results didn't stabilise, the conclusion felt obvious:

You needed to read better.

Over time, trading quietly became a test of how accurately you could interpret what was in front of you.

No one formally said it. The environment implied it.

And once that role is assigned, uncertainty becomes personal.

Every unclear move feels like something you should have understood.

Every loss feels like misreading.

Every win feels temporary — correct this time, but not yet reliable.

That isn't a flaw in you.

It's the natural consequence of believing the job is to be right.

And before anything else in this book can make sense, that belief has to be seen clearly.

Not attacked.

Not dismissed.

Just recognized.

Because what you thought trading was may not be what it actually requires.

## Chapter 3

### Why Effort Didn't Translate

Once trading is understood as interpretation, effort feels like responsibility.

If outcomes are inconsistent, you try harder.

If clarity fades, you study more.

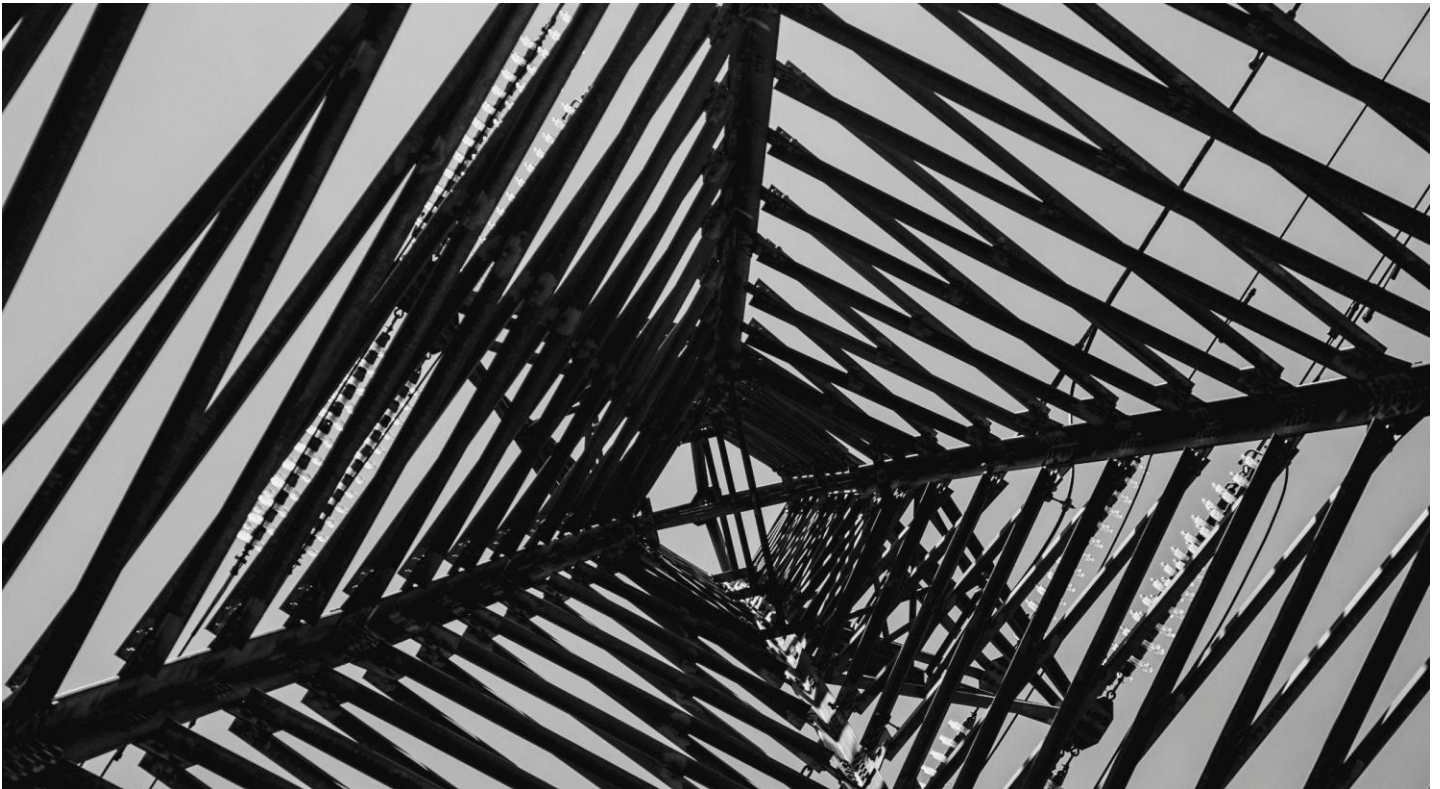
If confidence slips, you refine.

That response makes sense. It's what works in most areas of life.

It's also what slowly makes trading feel heavier.

Here's the part almost no one says clearly:

Trading doesn't reward effort the way other skill-based activities do.



More effort doesn't reduce uncertainty.

More analysis doesn't stabilize outcomes.

More refinement doesn't create safety.

Instead, effort quietly increases what each decision costs.

The moment you invest effort in being right, uncertainty becomes personal.

Losses stop being simple outcomes and start feeling explanatory.

Wins stop being neutral and start needing confirmation.

Every result carries more weight than it should.

That pressure isn't a psychological flaw.

It's the predictable result of carrying responsibility that the environment doesn't actually support.

This is why trading often feels easiest at the beginning.

Not because you were careless.

But because you hadn't yet confused effort with control.

As effort increases, the internal load increases with it.

More rules don't reduce pressure.

More confirmation doesn't remove doubt.

More discipline doesn't make uncertainty disappear.

They narrow responsibility — but in the wrong direction.

This is where most people turn inward.

"Maybe I'm not suited to this."

"Maybe I can't handle the pressure."

"Maybe I'm missing something fundamental."

Those thoughts feel honest.

They're also misplaced.

The discomfort wasn't evidence of personal failure.

It was evidence of misaligned responsibility.

You were trying to do something trading doesn't allow anyone to do:

Turn uncertainty into correctness through effort.

Once that's seen clearly, something important shifts.

The problem isn't you.

And it isn't psychological.

It's structural.

Before we talk about markets, tools, or methods, responsibility has to be narrowed — not expanded.

Not everything you were carrying was ever yours to carry.

In the next chapter, we step away from the trader completely and look at the one thing that has been shaping behaviour from the start:

The environment itself.

## Chapter 4

### Environments Shape Behaviour

Imagine you walk into a supermarket to buy a few basic things.

You're not rushed. You're not distracted. You have a short list in mind.

Milk. Bread. Something simple for dinner.

You grab a basket and start walking.

Almost immediately, you're met with displays. Bright signs. "Limited time offers." Items stacked at eye level.

You didn't come in for them — but you notice them anyway.

Staples are further back. Essentials are spread out. You pass aisles you hadn't planned to enter.

You're not being careless. You're not lacking discipline. You're responding to what's in front of you.

As you move through the store, small decisions accumulate. You pause. You compare. You add one or two extra items to the basket.

Not because you lost control, but because the environment quietly invited you to.

By the time you reach the checkout, your basket is heavier than you expected.

You didn't abandon your intention. You didn't forget your list. You didn't suddenly become impulsive.

You behaved exactly as the environment was designed to encourage.



Now imagine a different version of the same trip. Same intention. Same person. Same budget.

But this time, the store is organised differently. No promotional displays at the entrance. Staples grouped together, clear signage. Nothing competing aggressively for attention.

You still make decisions. You still choose. But the experience feels lighter.

You move with purpose. You spend less time evaluating. You leave with roughly what you intended to buy.

Again — nothing about *you* changed.

Your self-control didn't improve. Your discipline didn't increase. Your intelligence didn't suddenly sharpen.

Only the environment changed and with it, your behaviour. This is the part that's easy to miss.

When behaviour becomes effortful, we tend to blame the person.

We assume they lacked restraint. We assume they needed better habits.  
We assume they should "try harder."

But in environments like this, effort is not the primary driver.

Visibility is.

What's placed at eye level gets chosen more often. What's repeated feels important.  
What's easy to access gets acted on.

None of this requires manipulation. It doesn't require bad intentions.

It's simply how attention works. The environment answers questions before you consciously ask them.

What matters right now? What deserves consideration? What's worth responding to?

Once those answers are embedded in what you see, behaviour follows, quietly and consistently.

This is why earlier chapters focused so closely on effort and responsibility.

Not to criticise the trader —  
but to show that effort was being applied *inside a structure that already shaped behaviour*.

By the time frustration or self-doubt appears, the environment has already done its work.

The important shift is not learning to behave differently while standing in the same aisle.

It's recognising that the layout itself is not neutral.

Before we talk about methods, tools, or approaches, we need to look at what the trading environment places in front of you first — and what it quietly pushes to the edges.

Because long before skill ever has a chance to matter, behaviour has already been guided.

In the next chapter, we'll turn to the thing this environment claims to present most clearly — price — and ask a simple question that changes everything:

What is it, before it's arranged for you to see?

## Chapter 5

### What Price Actually Is

This chapter isn't about how price is used.

It's about what price is before anyone uses it.

Before it's analysed, interpreted, or explained, price exists in a much simpler form.

It opens. It moves. It closes. That's it.

Every trading day begins at a specific moment and ends at a specific moment. When the market opens, activity begins. When it closes, activity stops.

Inside that window, there are no natural compartments. No internal chapters. No built-in breaks.

Price does not arrive in pieces.

It unfolds continuously — like a single event in motion.

Think of the market open like a gate lifting.

Behind that gate is activity. Orders appear. Trades occur. Liquidity shifts. Everything that will happen that day happens while the gate is open.

When the gate closes, the activity ends.

Nothing inside that window is paused or segmented by time itself.

There are no five-minute "moments." No hourly or 4 hourly milestones.

There is only continuous interaction until the gate closes again.

All of the complexity people associate with price exists inside that open window — but the window itself is uninterrupted.

Price is not delivered in time blocks. It is delivered as continuous interaction.

Another way to see it is as a film playing in a cinema.

The doors open. The movie starts. The story unfolds. The credits roll. The doors close.

Now imagine something unusual.

Every five minutes, the viewer is replaced.

One person watches minutes 0–5.

Another watches 5–10.

Another watches 10–15.

Each leaves the theatre and tries to explain what the film is about based on a quick summary of what they saw.

They debate meaning. They speculate about what comes next.

But none of them experienced the whole film.

They didn't see continuity or cause and effect unfold.

They saw fragments.

The movie never changed.

Only the way it was experienced did.

Price works the same way.

The market does not pause every few minutes to create meaning or reset context.

It simply unfolds.

What most people call "price" is already a rearranged version of that unfolding.

By the time you see it, it has been sliced and grouped.

That doesn't make it wrong.

But it does mean it isn't the raw event anymore.

It's a representation of activity — not activity itself.

And once continuous behaviour is divided into segments, attention shifts.

Instead of seeing flow, you compare snapshots.

Instead of watching progression, you evaluate isolated moments and try look for patterns.

The questions start appearing naturally:

What does this mean?

Is this confirmation?

What happens next?

Those questions don't arise because the market became unclear.

They arise because continuity was interrupted.

The market didn't become uncertain. The experience of it did.

At its most basic level, price is simply what happens while the gate is open.

Nothing more. Nothing less.

Understanding that doesn't tell you how to trade.

But it does remove one important illusion:

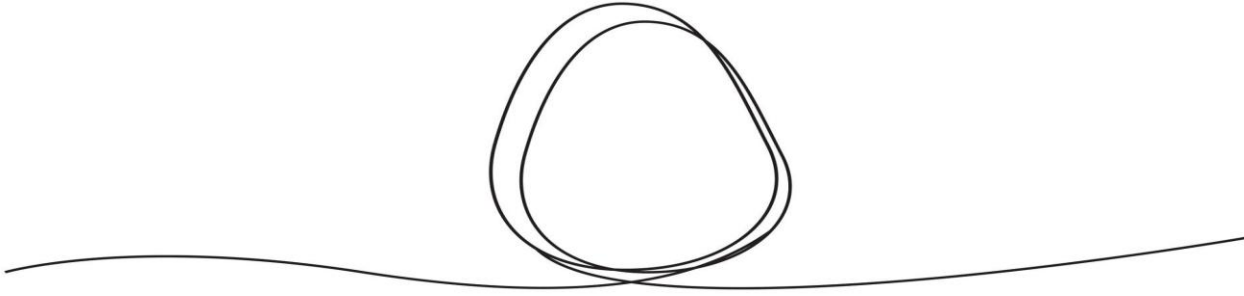
Time itself isn't shaping price in meaningful ways.

In the next chapter, we'll look at what quietly disappears when continuous activity is divided into pieces — and how that division reshapes behaviour long before strategy ever enters the picture.



## Chapter 6

### What Gets Lost Before You See It



Price is being divided for you, that is the lens, no matter which optical depth, be it 5 min, 1 hour or any other. What follows isn't about whether that division is right or wrong. It's about what it costs.

Once you understand price as a continuous event, something becomes unavoidable:

What you see is not what actually happened. It's what survived the way price was presented to you.

Every representation removes information. That isn't a flaw, it's what seemed logical and simple. You can't observe everything at once. Something always has to be condensed, so time was used.

The only real question is what gets removed.

When continuous activity is divided into segments, most of what happened inside those segments disappears.

You don't see sequence. You don't see hesitation. You don't see how long something took to resolve.

You see a summary.

Think again about the movie.

If someone tells you, "In this five-minute section, the story went up, down, and ended here," you technically know what happened. But you didn't experience it.

You didn't see the pause before the decision. You didn't feel the tension build. You didn't notice how quickly one moment followed another.

That texture is gone. Price works the same way. When activity is grouped, what survives is a compressed description:

Where it started.

Where it went.

Where it ended.



Everything else — the struggle, the acceleration, the stall, the rejection — is flattened.

That's why two very different periods of activity can look identical once they're summarised.

One may have been fast and decisive. Another slow and fragile.

But once compressed, they can appear the same. The loss isn't just detail. It's context.

And when context disappears, interpretation steps in to replace it.

You begin asking questions the data can no longer fully answer:

Was that strength or weakness?

Was that rejection or continuation?

Was that meaningful — or just noise?

Those questions feel reasonable. They're also unavoidable once information has been removed.

This is where effort quietly re-enters.

When something essential is missing, people compensate by thinking harder. They look for patterns. They compare examples. They add confirmation. They refine.

Not because they're undisciplined. But because the representation requires interpretation to fill the gaps it created.

Notice the order of events. First, information is removed. Then uncertainty increases. Then effort is applied to resolve that uncertainty.

By the time psychology becomes the focus, the real cause is already out of sight.

This also explains why debates about "which minute bar is better" rarely settle anything.

Different compressions lose different information. So people argue from what they can still see — unaware of what disappeared before the discussion even began.

None of this makes trading impossible. But it does explain why it often feels mentally expensive.

You're being asked to make decisions based on something that is already incomplete — and then to be confident about those decisions.

That tension doesn't come from markets being unpredictable.

It comes from working with a version of price where continuity has already been sacrificed.

This chapter is only asking you to notice something simple:

Before you analyse price, before you decide what it means, before you place a trade, something has already been taken away. And whatever is removed at that stage cannot be recovered later — no matter how much effort you apply and no matter what tools you attach to it, be it volume or anything else!

In the next chapter, we'll look at the practical consequence of that loss — not in theory, but in choice — and why where you participate matters more than most people realise.

## Chapter 7

### Choosing the Battlefield

Up to this point, we've talked about experience, effort, and structure.

Now we need to talk about something simpler — and more uncomfortable:

Not how trading works. But where it makes sense to attempt it.

One of the most damaging assumptions in retail trading is the idea that all markets are essentially the same — that only the strategy differs.

That isn't true.

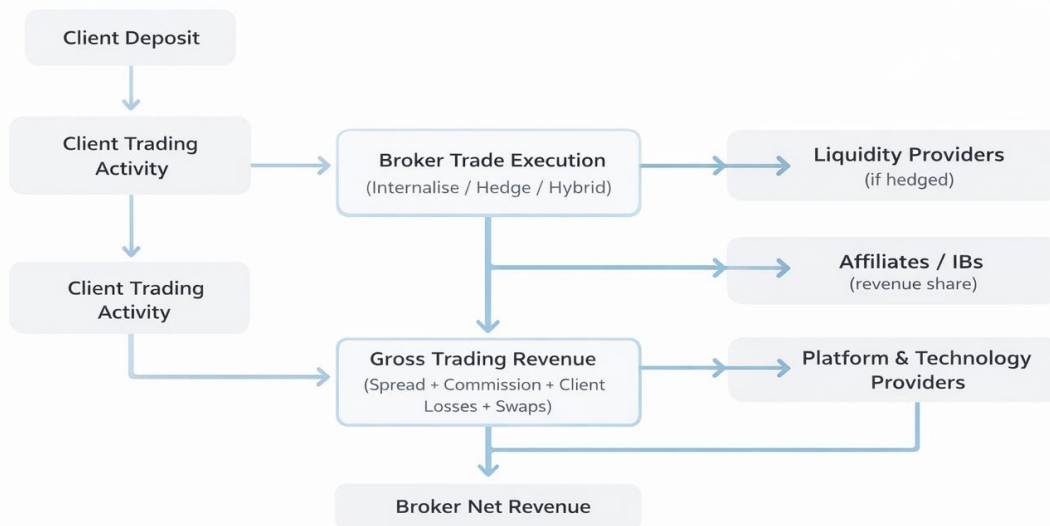
Markets aren't neutral arenas. They are environments with incentives.

And incentives matter.

Most traders never see a comparison. They're introduced to one environment and told that if it doesn't work, they need more discipline.

Let's remove that assumption.

**Retail Forex Broker — Revenue Flow (Simplified)**



Execution and hedging decisions vary by broker and client profile. Revenue sources are disclosed in client agreements.

## **The First Assumption: “If it’s popular, it must be viable”**

Search online for “how to trade” and you’ll notice something immediately.

Forex and CFD trading dominate the space.

Broker advertisements. Deposit bonuses. “Zero commission” claims. Chart pattern courses. Signal services. Automated strategies. Funded-account challenges.

That dominance isn’t proof of structural strength. It’s proof of marketing strength.

Retail Forex and CFD brokers can afford aggressive marketing for one simple reason: In many models, they are the counterparty to client trades. There is no shared central order book. No single marketplace where all participants compete directly.

In most retail Forex and CFD environments, the broker controls price delivery, sets and widens spreads, manages execution and may internalize order flow.

This isn’t an accusation. It’s the disclosed structure in the fine print!

As your trading activity generates revenue directly, volume is valuable. That’s why high leverage is encouraged, frequent trading is rewarded, bonuses exist, affiliate commissions can be substantial (up to 50% client deposits are paid to marketers\*\*). The key point isn’t morality. It’s alignment.

*\*\* Public examples of these structures are included in Appendix A at the end of the book.*

### **Worth noting: funded accounts are still businesses**

The recent growth of funded-account programs deserves a brief mention because the same principle applies: incentives shape behaviour.

A low entry fee can look like opportunity, but at scale it creates a powerful business model: traders pay for challenges, fail strict conditions, reset, and try again. The trader sees a path to capital. The firm sees repeatable account turnover.

That is the uncomfortable part: the model does not need most traders to become skilled. It only needs most traders to stay hopeful. Hope becomes the renewable resource.

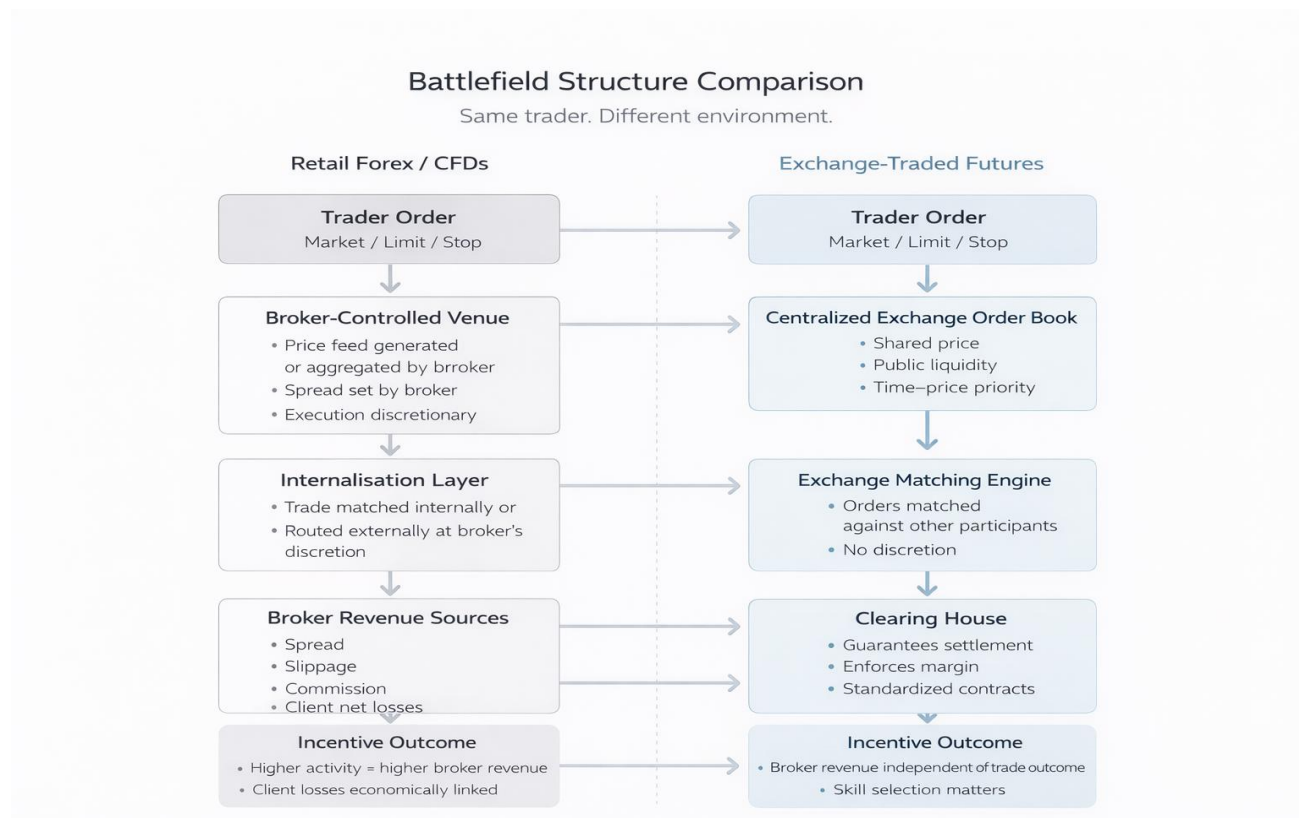
This does not mean nobody succeeds, and it does not mean these programs have no practical use. Many traders use them simply as a cheaper way to access a platform, live data, and a structured trading environment while they learn. Used that way, they can be useful. But they should be understood as access, not education.

One red flag is the treatment of automation. Many firms restrict or prohibit automated trading, and in some cases there may be legitimate reasons for that, especially where copy trading, latency abuse, or exploitative behaviour is concerned. But a properly structured automated process is not the same thing. It can reduce impulse, hesitation, revenge trading, and emotional over-management. So when a firm restricts automation entirely while still encouraging manual challenge attempts under pressure, the question is worth asking: is the structure mainly helping traders demonstrate skill, or preserving the conditions under which most traders fail?

Funded accounts are best understood as a stepping stone, not the destination. For many traders, they provide low-cost access to a platform, live data, and a structured trading environment without immediately committing larger personal capital. Used that way, they can be useful. But access is not mastery. Once real skill, consistency, and confidence develop, the objective is no longer to keep paying for permission to trade inside someone else’s rules. The objective is to outgrow the exercise, not remain dependent on it, to develop the structure, judgement, and control required to trade on your own terms.

## The Second Assumption: “You’re trading the same market as the banks”

You aren’t.



When institutions like Banks trade currencies or commodities at scale, they always operate in regulated, centralised exchange environments, they are not trading against Brokers, they are not trading “Forex” like it is advertised on Social media, and why should they when a structured environment exists?

Retail Forex, as it is commonly marketed online, is not the same environment. In many cases, the broker is a private business operating under light oversight, often from jurisdictions chosen specifically because the rules are softer, and the commercial model allows them to profit from spreads, commissions, client activity, and client failure. That is not a fair playing field. It is a business model wrapped in the language of opportunity, which is exactly why aggressive promotions, affiliate deals, and commission-driven endorsements flood the internet.

So what is a structured, regulated environment?

It’s called exchange-traded Futures and not only limited to Banks!

In Futures markets:

- Orders meet in a centralised matching engine (not broker manipulated)
- Price is shared across all participants (large and small, individual or institutional)
- Trades are cleared through a central, regulated clearing house (yes, even individual traders entries)
- Contracts and margin rules are standardised

Future's Brokers are clearing houses, not taking the opposite side, their role is primarily administrative:

- Provide access
- Route orders
- Manage margin
- Charge transparent fees

The broker is not the house. It doesn't own the wheel. That distinction changes incentives completely.

Choosing a structurally fair environment doesn't guarantee success. But it removes structural misalignment.

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## **A Necessary Clarification**

Some readers will think:

"I already trade Futures."

That matters. But it isn't the full picture.

A fair battlefield can still be viewed through an unhelpful lens.

Time-based charts. Candlestick patterns. Interpretive indicators.

These tools aren't malicious.

But many were designed to be teachable, marketable, and visually compelling — not necessarily to reduce uncertainty.

Bright patterns are easy to sell. Frequent signals keep people engaged.

Engagement generates activity. Activity generates revenue. Even in a fair environment.

So some traders step onto a legitimate battlefield — but still experience:

- Constant urgency
- Interpretive overload
- Effort without clarity

The environment may be aligned. The representation may not be.

That distinction matters. And we'll address it directly.

## **The Third Assumption: “If it’s difficult, it must be legitimate”**

Some environments are difficult because they’re competitive. Others are difficult because they’re structurally distorted. Those aren’t the same.

A fair environment has:

Shared price. Transparent execution. Enforced rules.

An unfair one obscures:

Who you’re trading against. How price is formed. Where incentives sit.

Many retail traders mistake complexity for legitimacy. Noise for sophistication.

When indicators multiply and time fragments price, clarity doesn’t increase. It decreases.

The result isn’t healthy competition. It’s cognitive overload. That costs people years.

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## **The Decision Point**

At this stage, nothing complicated is being asked.

Not belief. Not loyalty. Not a strategy.

Just this:

Are you willing to participate only where:

- Price is shared
- Rules are enforced
- Incentives are not structurally aligned against you

If the answer is no, that’s fine.

But everything that follows assumes the answer is yes.

The rest of this book is not about fighting harder inside distorted systems.

It’s about choosing an environment that makes sense — and then learning how to operate within it properly.

What most traders inherit without question is not the market itself, but the way the market is presented to them. That presentation feels natural only because it has become familiar.

But price was not always encountered as fragments, intervals, and constant prompts for interpretation.

Before the screen, it was experienced as shared activity — visible, continuous, and governed by the same rules for everyone involved.

To understand what was later added, distorted, and mistaken for meaning, we first need to step back and see what trading looked like before it was packaged for display.

## Chapter 8

### Before the Screen

Before trading was something you looked at, it was something you stood inside.

Price wasn't organised for interpretation. It was experienced as activity.

In the pit, trading happened in one place, at one time, under shared rules. Everyone saw the same bids and offers. Everyone competed for the same liquidity.

Nothing arrived pre-arranged. If buying became aggressive, you saw it.

If selling stalled, you felt it. If participation dried up, the room changed.

Price didn't come in pieces. It came as events.

A trade happened. Then another. Then nothing. Then a rush.

Time passed — but it wasn't segmented.

What mattered wasn't the minute. It was what changed while time passed.

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### How Price Was Recorded

Price still needed to be captured. That role belonged to the ticker tape.

The tape printed each transaction in sequence — symbol, price, sometimes volume. No grouping. No summaries. No interpretation.

If nothing happened, nothing printed.

That alone tells you something important:

Price was defined by activity, not by time.

Traders didn't read patterns from the tape.

They sensed pressure.

Speed.

Pauses.

Acceleration.

Exhaustion.

The tape was a record — not a guide.

## How Price Was Reviewed

After the session ended, the record became something else.

It was studied.

Charts were drawn — often by hand — to answer retrospective questions:

What happened today?

Where did activity concentrate?

How did price move from open to close?

These early charts were summaries.

A daily bar made sense because a trading session had a natural boundary: the open and the close.

Everything in between belonged to that day.

Nothing smaller than that carried independent meaning.

There was no reason for a five-minute bar to exist.

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## When the Screen Replaced the Pit

As pits declined and screens took over, something fundamental shifted.

The crowd disappeared. With it, direct visibility.

Price could no longer be experienced. It had to be presented.

And once something must be presented, it must be organised.

If price had been displayed honestly — as continuous activity between open and close — sessions would visually resolve into a single bar.

Accurate. But static.

There would be little to react to moment by moment.

So segmentation became the default.



## The Birth of Defaults

Time-based bars did not appear because the market demanded them.

They appeared because platforms needed a way to present continuous activity in a form people could repeatedly interact with.

Not for structural clarity, but for usability, familiarity, and constant engagement.

One-minute bars.

Five-minute bars.

Fifteen-minute bars...

The trading session — naturally continuous between open and close — was divided into equal time intervals so that activity could be packaged into manageable, repeatable units.

Not because the market moves in equal intervals, but because once trading moved onto digital platforms, equal segmentation became the simplest way to make price visually active and commercially usable.

That distinction matters.

Trading platforms are businesses before they are educational environments.

Their objective is to keep the experience accessible, engaging, and active enough that participation continues. The more often traders feel they are seeing something, the more often they are tempted to do something. Once that structure became the default, everything else followed.

Books explained what these intervals supposedly meant.

Patterns were named.

Candles were named.

Rules were written.

Indicators multiplied.

“Methods” were encapsulated into time segments.

Meaning was not discovered inside those segments. It was layered onto them.

That is why so much trading education begins with the platform’s defaults and rarely questions them.

The trader is taught how to read the presentation, not whether the presentation itself is distorting what matters.

Webinars, tutorials, guru interviews, platform walkthroughs, and free training all tend to orbit the same assumption: that the default view is a neutral starting point.

It is not. It is a commercial interface.

If platforms had chosen to present the session as a single structural unit — one open, one close, everything in between — there would have been far less to label and far fewer moments that appeared urgent simply because a clock completed its cycle. Equal time segmentation created rhythm.

Rhythm created perceived opportunity. And perceived opportunity encouraged participation.

Not because the market changed. Because the presentation did.

## How Behaviour Changed

Once price was divided into frequent, discrete units, behaviour shifted.

Each bar felt complete.

Each close felt significant.

Each new bar felt like opportunity.

The mind did what it always does with fragments. It tried to connect them.

What does this mean?

How does this relate to the last one?

What pattern is forming?

This style of thinking didn't arise because markets became more complex.

It arose because fragmentation became normal. Trading moved from selective participation to constant engagement. Observation became interpretation.

Participation became reaction. The more reaction the more profits for trading platforms and Brokers.

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## What Actually Changed

None of this was introduced as distortion.

It was introduced as progress.

More access.

More tools.

More visibility.

And in many ways, that's true.

But one change went mostly unnoticed. The trader no longer stood inside shared activity.

They stood outside it, watching pre-segmented pieces arrive on a screen.

The market didn't change. The presentation did.

Before screens, price was constrained by activity.

After screens, it was constrained by defaults.

That shift reshaped behaviour long before anyone began discussing psychology, discipline, or skill.

Before we move forward, one final contrast remains:

What happens when price is shared, continuous, and rule-bound — not sliced into defaults before you ever see it?

That's where we go next.

## Chapter 9

### What Was Missing

Something was wrong long before the result appeared. Trading demanded attention without resolving uncertainty, and more effort never produced more clarity.

Wins did not stabilise confidence; losses felt explanatory even when they were not.

None of that was random, and none of it was personal.

You've already seen the structure:

- Some environments reward activity, not outcomes.
- Some markets are structurally misaligned.
- Time-based segmentation was inherited, not chosen.
- Interpretation replaced participation.

The problem was never your discipline. It was what you were being asked to interpret.

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### The Weight You Were Carrying

Every bar looked important, every close felt meaningful, and every new candle demanded evaluation.

Stillness felt uncomfortable; silence felt like missed opportunity.

So you refined, added confirmation, changed timeframes, and tried harder.

The pressure increased because interpretation under uncertainty is expensive.

You were trying to extract meaning from summaries, and that task does not resolve.

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### The Structural Problem

Here it is plainly: price was being organised into equal time intervals before you ever engaged with it.

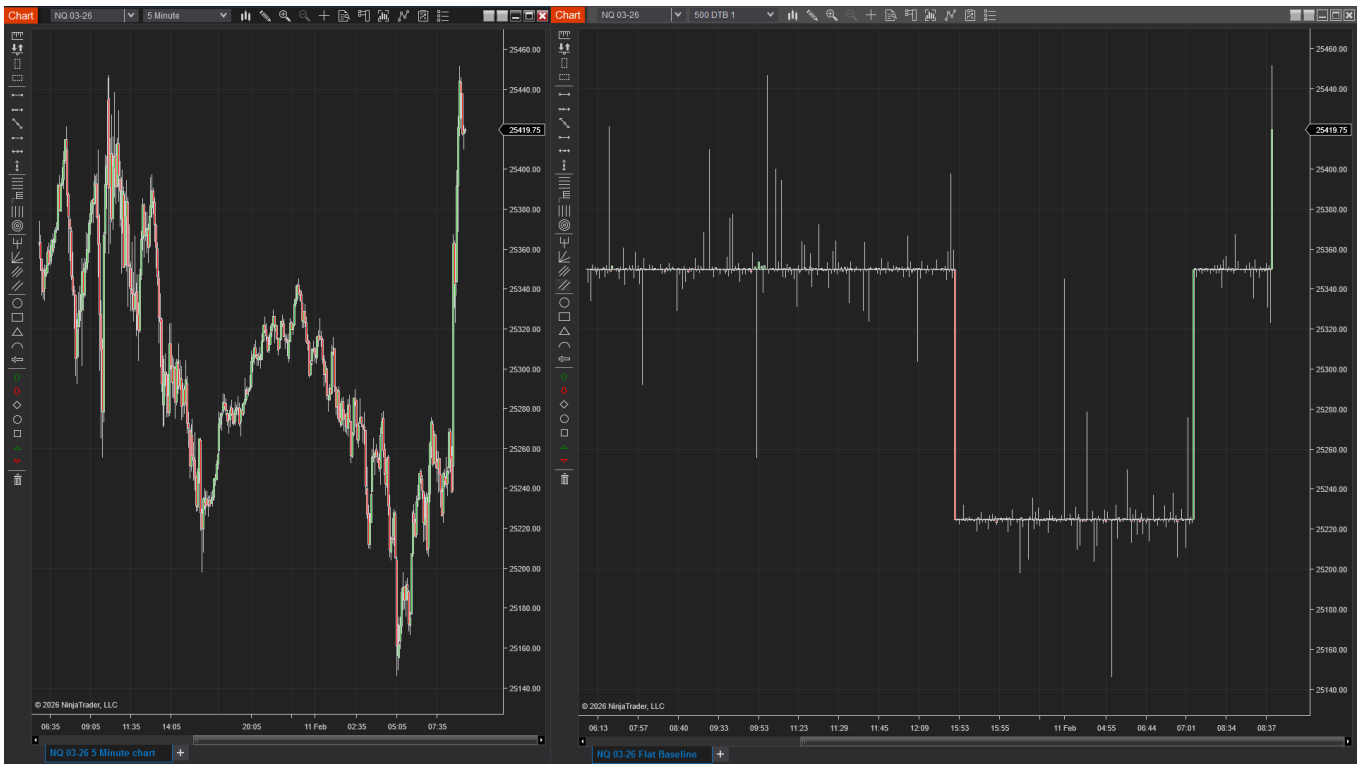
One minute, five minutes, fifteen minutes — regardless of whether participation had meaningfully changed.

Each completed interval produced a new bar because the clock completed its cycle, not because something significant occurred. That segmentation quietly shaped attention.

It suggested something had finished and implied something new had begun, even when participation remained unchanged. You did not choose that structure; it was the platform default.

Once price is segmented into equal time intervals, interpretation becomes mandatory, because every interval appears evaluative even when nothing structural shifted. That is where the mental cost begins.

## What That Looks Like in Practice



Same instrument. Same session. Same price.

On the left, structure forms because time passes.

On the right, structure forms only when participation shifts.

The underlying data is identical. What changes is what demands your attention.

When time organises price, bars arrive on schedule whether anything meaningful happened or not. When participation organises price, nothing forms unless behaviour changes.

That difference is not cosmetic. It is structural.

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## When Time Stops Organising Price

The solution is not better interpretation. It is removing time as the organiser.

When price is organised by participation instead of minutes, something immediate changes.

Nothing forms unless activity changes. Nothing closes unless pressure shifts. Silence remains visible.

Bars stop arriving on schedule. They arrive only when something structural occurs.

Urgency appears only when it is real. Interpretation reduces — not because you became more skilled, but because there is less to interpret. Decisions do not become easier. They become cheaper.

## What This Actually Does

This approach does not predict direction. It does not forecast outcomes. It does not eliminate risk.

It changes the frame.

When a participation bar forms, it defines a baseline. From that point, price has only two structural possibilities:

- Return to that baseline
- Establish a new one

There is no third state.

Price either returns to the baseline that was established, or it establishes a new one. Those are the only structural possibilities available. That is not prediction. It is constraint. It is clarity!

And constraint changes everything, because when structure is constrained, imagination has less room to interfere. Interpretation has fewer surfaces to attach to. Urgency loses its artificial fuel.

What disappears is artificial segmentation — the constant slicing of activity into equal time fragments that imply significance where there may be none.

What disappears is the obligation to evaluate every minute.

The pressure to react to every close.

The sense that something must be done simply because another bar has printed.

What remains is participation responding to itself.

Directly. Visibly. Without time imposing narrative.

Without the clock manufacturing momentum.

And that shift matters more than it first appears.

Because when structure is artificial, responsibility feels constant. Every interval demands attention. Every movement feels actionable. Every pause feels like risk.

You begin to live inside reaction. That is the weight most traders never describe clearly.

The sense that nothing ever settles. That you are always one bar behind.

That clarity never lasts. That silence feels like you are missing something.

Not because you lack discipline. Not because you lack intelligence.

But because the environment never stabilises.

When segmentation stops manufacturing urgency, something else happens.

Stillness becomes visible. Absence becomes information.

You are no longer required to extract meaning from fragments.

You are allowed to wait. And that is not passive. It is structural alignment.



This image represents the inherited frame.

A continuous feed of completed intervals.

A structure where activity is divided into equal time units, whether participation meaningfully changed or not.

Nothing here is inherently wrong. It is simply the default most traders begin inside.

Each bar appears finished. Each interval suggests that something has occurred. Each close invites evaluation. The rhythm is constant.

New information arrives on schedule — regardless of whether anything structural has shifted.

Over time, attention adapts to that rhythm.

Evaluation becomes continuous.

Responsibility feels uninterrupted.

Nothing settles before the next interval appears. So you refine. You add filters. You seek confirmation.

Not because you lack discipline, but because the structure keeps presenting fragments that imply significance.

The fatigue that follows is not personal.

It is the predictable effect of being asked to extract clarity from segmentation.

This is not a flawed trader. It is a frame that never stabilises long enough to reduce doubt.

## Structure Restored

Up to this point, nothing has been added.

No new method.

No new indicator.

No promise of easier outcomes.

The work has been subtractive because distortion had to be removed before anything useful could be seen.

What has changed is not price.

It is the frame around it.

Time is no longer being treated as the thing that gives price meaning.

Artificial urgency has been exposed.

Responsibility has been narrowed back to what the trader can actually manage.

That matters because when structure reflects participation instead of elapsed minutes, behaviour begins to settle.

Stillness no longer feels like failure.

Silence no longer demands explanation.

Attention is no longer pulled forward by a clock.

Participation does not mean constant action.

It means the moments where activity materially shifts and structure is actually being established, tested, reclaimed, or replaced.

It is the visible behaviour of price when something meaningful is happening — not every fluctuation, not every printed interval, and not every movement the clock forces onto the screen.

To manage participation is not to predict direction.

It is not to interpret every fragment.

It is to respond when structure changes, hold steady when it does not, and make decisions inside a frame where silence is allowed to remain silence.

That is why this is not a tactic.

It is the condition required before tactics stop becoming noise.

Once that condition is restored, only one question remains:

What does it look like to engage with price inside a structure that is aligned from the beginning — not just in theory, but in practice?

That is what comes next.

# Final Chapter

## What Happens Next

If you've read this far, something has already shifted.

Not because you were convinced. Not because you were persuaded.

Because the old frame no longer holds.

You now understand:

- Effort alone never stabilised outcomes.
- Interpretation compounded uncertainty.
- Time-based charts manufactured activity.
- Environment mattered more than strategy.
- You were never meant to predict price.

You were meant to manage participation. Participation in an environment without noise.

That distinction is structural.

And once seen, it cannot be unseen.

Before we go further, one direct truth:

Ninety-five percent of retail traders lose money. That number is not normal.

If 95% of flights failed, aviation would be rebuilt.

If 95% of surgeries failed, medicine would stop the procedure.

In trading, the system stays the same — and the individual is blamed. That tells you something.

This is not a discipline problem.

It is a design problem.



## The Requirement That Remains

At this point, explanation has done its work.

Only one requirement remains:

A way to engage with price that:

- Does not force constant interpretation.
- Does not manufacture urgency.
- Does not rely on prediction.
- Does not convert hindsight into personal blame.

That requirement is operational. Not philosophical. Not motivational.

Operational.

Because here is the uncomfortable truth:

Retail trading is built on time-sliced charts. MOST trading education is centred around them!

But exchanges do not produce five-minute bars. They open price. They define the boundaries. Price moves inside those boundaries. They close price.

There are hard upper limits. Hard lower limits. If they are hit, trading stops — for everyone. Now look at a five-minute chart. Where do you see price levels? You don't. You see time. You see noise.

Institutions trade levels. Retail traders are taught to read candles and find pictures.

Platforms chop that raw flow into neat time intervals — then entire ecosystems of indicators are built on top of those slices. Moving averages. VWAPs. Oscillators. Chart patterns. Candlestick analysis. 100's and 100's of consuming names and pictures your mind has to process instead of seeing price cleanly without the need of ANY of them. No wonder it brings fatigue and uncertainty!

Everything designed to interpret something that was artificially fragmented to begin with.

It is like building extra rooms on a house that was poured on sand. You can improve the paint. You can redesign the kitchen. You can add better lighting. But the foundation remains unstable.

That is why so many fail. And it also explains why this industry depends so heavily on urgency, spectacle, and constant reinvention. Countdown timers. "Get in quick" offers. New indicators. New strategies. New experts. New excitement, week after week, email after email. Because when the underlying structure is broken, the easiest business model is not to fix it — it is to keep dressing it up and selling it again.

That is where the DTB System parts ways with almost everything else in this industry.

It was not built on selling and marketing bits and pieces, manufacture excitement, or keep traders dependent on constant stimulation. It was built with unusual depth, care, and precision to address the parts of trading that actually matter. Not just to look impressive, but to function as a complete environment a serious trader can rely on.

Most of this industry is built to sell hope inside a broken frame, not to repair the frame itself.

The DTB System was built from the opposite instinct: to take trading seriously enough to design around what protects the trader, supports sound decisions, and holds up in real use.

## **What the DTB System changes**

The DTB System removes time from the center of decision-making and replaces it with structure. That is the foundation and starting point, because everything is built on that.

Price is no longer organised around elapsed minutes, but around meaningful shifts in participation and clearly defined price levels. Structure forms only when something materially changes — not because a clock advances.

When nothing changes, nothing forms. There is no artificial rhythm and no pressure to act simply because an interval has completed. Activity appears only when it is earned.

That shift alters everything downstream.

Because when structure leads instead of time, attention stabilises. Decision-making slows to match reality. The impulse to react to every movement fades, and engagement becomes deliberate rather than restless.

The result is not more information. It is clearer information.

Not more activity, but activity that carries weight.

That is the foundation of the DTB System.

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## **What It Feels Like — and How We Begin**

You won't be overwhelmed, and you won't be thrown into complexity.

In the environment of Retail trading many providers sell trading courses and promote "Community", not a bad thing in itself but \$5000 - \$15000 to learn a manual trading method is where their business revenue lies. Individual trading strategies sell for \$1000's and offer a "replacement" guarantee, and once the sale is in they continue to promote additional tools heavily, cycling through the 95% with hard sell tactics. On the other side there are these "\$47" or similar promotions that sound amazing but lack actual, sustainable structure. You can count on 1 hand those offering a System of tools on a low subscription without an upfront lump sum.

This is where DTB Traders is positioned, without an upfront outlay and on a low subscription model if this is a good fit for you, and enough time to work with it before you outlay a penny!

In the first week, we strip everything back and lay out price clearly — not patterns, not pictures, but levels. You'll see how price moves between defined boundaries and begin to recognise structure without forcing interpretation. The complimentary program covers everything from setup to real time, real world trading.

By the end of that first week, something shifts. You stop scanning for signals and start observing behaviour. The need to interpret every movement fades because not every movement matters.

In the second week, we introduce supporting tools — not to add noise, but to confirm structure. You begin to see how participation forms around levels and how engagement becomes conditional rather than constant.

Then we show you how to operate an automated strategy built on those same levels. You're not guessing entries or chasing candles. You're managing participation inside defined structure.

One to two hours a day is enough to work in this environment. Within the first week, you'll know whether this feels different — not because someone tells you it is, but because your decision-making slows down. The pressure reduces. Clarity replaces urgency. That is the experience..

## The First Month

The first month exists for one reason: to let you experience the difference before you are asked to commit further. You do not need to absorb the entire DTB System straight away. You only need enough exposure to see whether this way of trading brings clarity, reduces pressure, and actually makes sense.

To make that possible, an automated strategy preset is included from day one that can run without your intervention. It is there to keep things moving while you learn the structure properly, following a simple principle: **Earn While You Learn**. Yes, I want you to start earning from day one, week one.

Sneak peek here: [link to YouTube video](#)

But make no mistake: the goal is not passive dependence. Automation is a bridge, not the destination. It is there to help you start well, not to save you from ever having to think. Genuine trading skill still comes from understanding structure and making decisions when they matter.

This brings us back to the question raised at the beginning of this book.

If the advertised patterns, shortcuts, and fixed-time “methods” worked with real consistency, they would not need to be sold through hype, urgency, and endless motivational content. They would have been automated, institutionalised, or quietly exploited long ago.

That is not what most traders are being sold.

They are being sold certainty where none exists, simplicity where deeper judgement is required, and confidence before the environment has been properly understood.

The DTB System does not pretend trading can be reduced to a catchphrase, a candle pattern, or a 90-minute formula. It was built from the opposite belief: that serious trading requires structure, restraint, context, and tools designed to reduce noise rather than manufacture excitement.

That is what the first month reveals.

Not false excitement. Not a motivational rush.

A clear answer.

### **Is this for you, or not?**

One month is enough to know. If it is not aligned, you walk away.

If it is, continued access is \$399 every six months — about \$66 per month for the complete DTB System.

Everything included. Nothing hidden. Nothing extra waiting behind the curtain.

No fragmented tools. No upsell ladder. No nonsense.

Just one complete system, continued access, and a straightforward subscription.

All I ask is that you trust your instinct. If something in this book resonated, if you recognised the flaw in the old framework, if clarity felt like relief rather than excitement, then the next step is simple:

Step inside and evaluate it properly.

Run the automated strategy templates provided so you can benefit right away, you don't need years of learning to start being profitable, it's a great benefit to see returns before the full structure is understood.

Do not rush. Do not hope. Do not force conviction.

Just assess it for what it is, from structure rather than emotion.

This is also an invitation to those who have had access to the DTB System before, but not with the guided experience it required. Much has been refined since then with education, and that is exactly why this reintroduction matters. If you saw the potential before, you will understand why it is worth seeing again in a clearer, more practical form.

The DTB System runs on NinjaTrader.

If you already use NinjaTrader, the transition is straightforward.

If you do not, getting started is still simple. NinjaTrader provides complimentary short-term access to the platform and real-time data, and many funded account programs include both platform access and data at very low cost.

You do not need much to begin. You only need access, guidance, and enough time to evaluate it properly.

Begin your 1-month full-access evaluation here:

[Complimentary 1 Month access and Training.](#)

Don't enter casually. Enter deliberately.

If the old frame no longer holds, this is where it changes.

I look forward to introducing you to a system I built to bring structure, clarity, and a more honest way of working with the markets.

**Jason Taylor**

Founder, DTB Traders

## Appendix A — Sources & Transparency

This appendix provides public, verifiable examples of affiliate, referral, and revenue-share incentive structures referenced in Chapter 7. They are included for transparency, not persuasion. Their purpose is to make clear that the incentives described in this book are real, visible, and commercially embedded — and that they do not always align with the interests of the trader.

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### **\*[1] UpTrader — How Forex Broker Affiliate Programs Work**

Explains common revenue-share and CPA models used by Forex brokers, including percentage-based revenue sharing from referred traders.

<https://upt trader.io/en/articles/331/how-forex-broker-affiliate-program-works>

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### **\*[2] Exness Affiliate Program**

Publicly advertises revenue-share commissions of up to **40% based on referred client trading activity**.

<https://www.exnessaffiliates.com>

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### **\*[3] Deriv Partner Program**

Advertises revenue-share commissions of up to **45% of trading revenue**.

<https://deriv.com/partners>

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### **\*[4] Retail Forex Market Structure**

The foreign exchange market is decentralized and operates over-the-counter (OTC), meaning there is no central exchange where all trades are matched and executed. Retail forex brokers act as intermediaries and, in many cases, **take the opposite side of retail client trades**, providing a trading environment rather than direct access to a shared exchange.

<https://www.nasdaqtrader.com/content/phlxwco/forex.pdf>

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### **\*[5] Retail Forex Market Structure and Broker Counterparty Role**

Public educational material from BabyPips confirms that retail Forex traders do not trade on a central exchange, do not trade with other traders, and instead enter principal-to-principal contracts where the broker is the sole counterparty, internalises order flow, and may profit directly from client losses.

While such materials describe the structure accurately, Chapter 7 focuses on the *implications* of this structure when compared with exchange-cleared markets where these conflicts are prohibited.

Source:

<https://www.babypips.com/learn/forex/where-retail-forex-traders-trade>

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### **Clarifying Note**

Affiliate revenue-share programs typically pay partners a percentage of broker revenue (such as spreads, commissions, swaps, and execution-related income) generated by referred clients. Structures and percentages vary by broker and jurisdiction.

They may also pay referring marketers a % of client deposits thus fueling the marketing campaigns creating more noise.

**NO COMMISSIONS ARE PAID IN THE FUTURES MARKET AND NO TRADING ACTIVITY OR CLIENT CAPITAL IS PAID AS COMMISSIONS TO ANYONE!** That is why we stay AWAY from Forex and CFD trading!

**Please read the Risk Disclosure below as it is important to understand that trading the markets does involve risk:**

# Futures Trading & DTB Traders Risk Disclosure

Futures trading contains substantial risk and is not for every investor.

An investor could potentially lose all or more than the initial investment.

Risk capital is money that can be lost without jeopardizing ones' financial security or life style.

Only risk capital should be used for trading and only those with sufficient risk capital should consider trading.

Past performance is not necessarily indicative of future results, results may be shared publicly however these are not guaranteed.

All DTB Products are provided with no guarantee of returns, as no such guarantee can be made either lawfully or otherwise.

Your degree of success is dependent on your risk management and thoughtful consideration when entering and exiting positions in the market.

The tools DTB Traders provide are designed to help you understand the market and see what price is likely to do next, however you are ultimately responsible for how you make use of them.

Finally, DTB Traders ONLY recommends trading Futures on a regulated exchange, Forex trading is NOT endorsed or supported AT ALL.